

ZOMATO Product Design:

Visual Customizer Feature-

Food delivery platforms primarily rely on static lists and text-based menus for food selection, which often leads to user confusion, decision fatigue, and low engagement. This study explores visual food customization interfaces—as shown in the provided burger customization model—as a more effective approach to menu browsing and decision-making. The research argues that replacing or supplementing Zomato's current list-based system with interactive visual customization can significantly improve user satisfaction, confidence, and conversion rates.

Current state of customization in the Zomato app-

Zomato's current interface presents users with long lists of dishes, small thumbnails, and minimal interaction. While functional, this system forces users to imagine food composition, portion size, and customization options mentally.

In contrast, visual customization systems allow users to directly see the ingredients, portions, and preferences in real time. This study investigates how such systems improve user experience compared to Zomato's existing design.

The Problem we are fixing-

Zomato uses:

- Text-heavy menus
- Inconsistent food images
- Hidden customization options

Users must rely on imagination, which increases uncertainty and reduces trust. Customization is usually buried in pop-ups, limited to checkboxes, lacking visual feedback. This creates friction and discourages exploration.

Our Solution-

The interface shown in our version introduces:

- Layer-by-layer food visualization
- Real-time ingredient changes
- Visual portions
- Direct manipulation of toppings

Instead of reading options, users see their food being built.

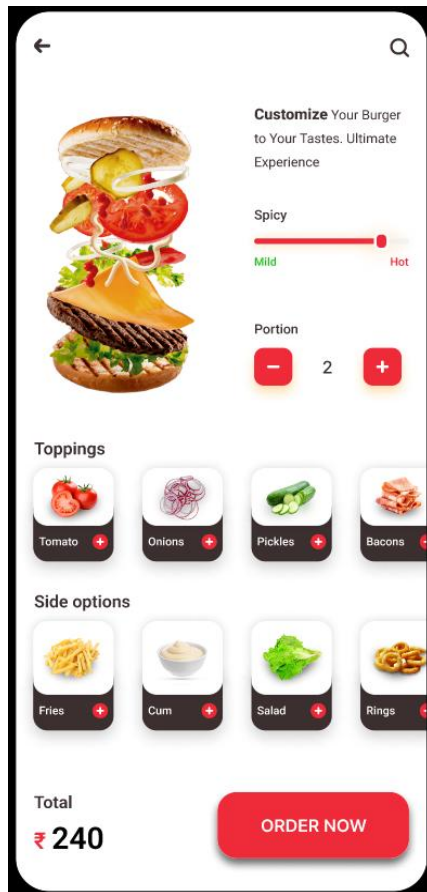


Fig1.1- before adding onions

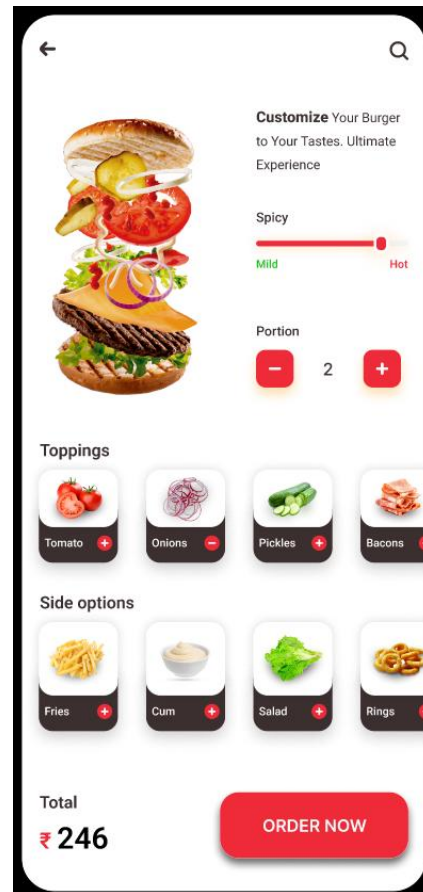


Fig1.2- after adding onions

Current workflow-

Start>>

Open Zomato App>>

Home Screen (Recommendations)>>

Search / Browse Restaurants>>

Apply Filters (Price, Rating, Distance)>>

Restaurant List>>

Select Restaurant>>

Menu List (Text + Thumbnails)>>

Scroll Menu>>

Tap Item>>

Customization Popup (Checkboxes)>>

Add to Cart>>

Checkout



Fig 1.3 – Current topping customization menu/ system

Improved user flow-

Start>>

Open Zomato App>>

Home Screen (Personalized)>>

Select Dish Category (e.g. Burger)>>

Visual Food Builder Screen>>

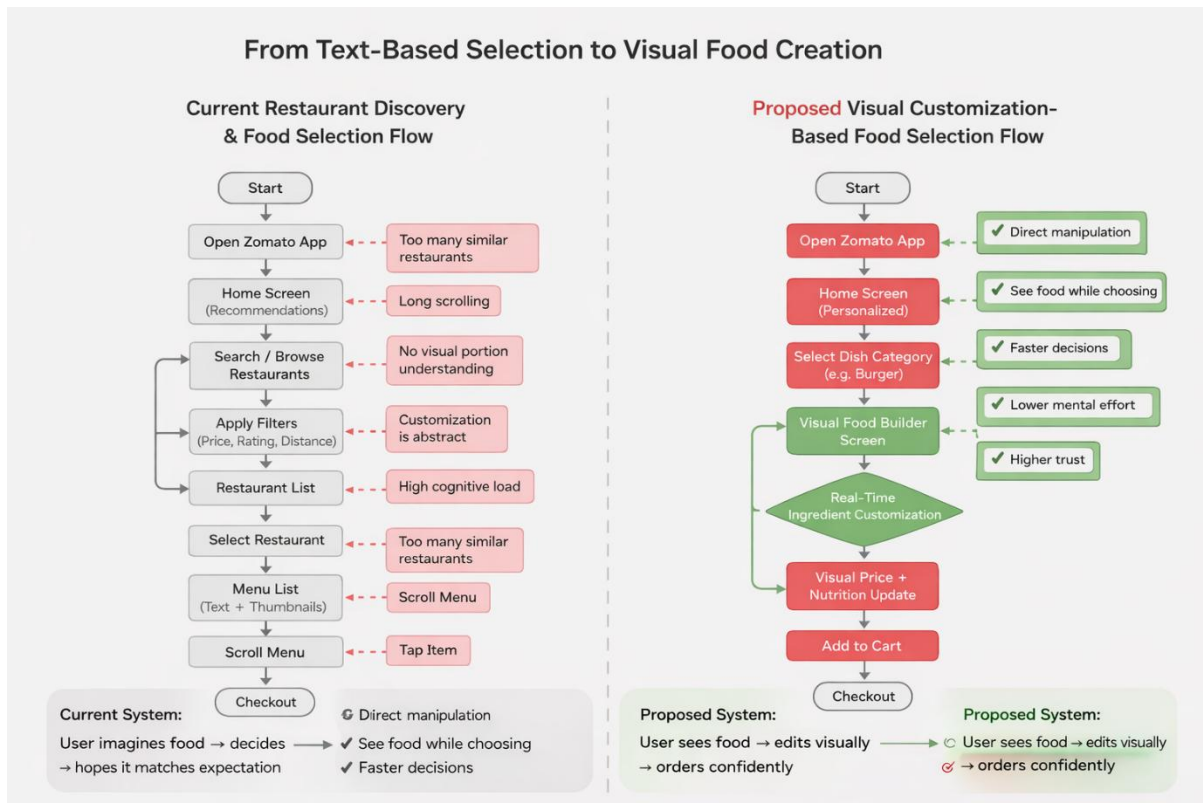
Real-Time Ingredient Customization>>

Visual Price >>

Confirm Custom Dish>>

Add to Cart>>

Checkout



Flowchart 1.1- Before and After user flow chart

User Persona-

Name: Tejal Agarwal
 Age: 18
 Occupation: College Student
 Location: IIT Roorkee
 Tech Savviness: MID TIER
 Platform: Zomato (mobile)

Her goals are to quickly decide what to eat without overthinking and customize food to match mood and cravings. She often scrolls through food apps daily and gets overwhelmed by long menus. Like many she enjoys visually rich, interactive apps.

Some pain points during her ordering process are that she can't imagine portion size from text and feels that there are too many similar options. Furthermore, customization feels hidden and confusing.

Benefits of Visual Customization

Reduced Cognitive Load

Users no longer imagine outcomes. The system shows results instantly, reducing mental effort.

Furthermore, User Confidence increases by seeing exact ingredients builds trust in:

- Food quality
- Portion size
- Custom orders

This increases likelihood of purchase, increased engagement and interactive visuals turn ordering into an experience, not a task. This improves session duration, emotional attachment, brand perception.

Most platforms (Swiggy, Uber Eats, DoorDash) use static menus and offer minimal visual customization along with the fact that they mostly only depend on filters and text labels.

“None treat food selection as a visual design process.”

-Aseel Shihab

Conclusion-

Visual customization offers clear advantages over Zomato’s current system by reducing uncertainty, improving trust, enhancing engagement, supporting faster decisions. By adopting interactive visual food builders, Zomato can move from a listing platform to a next-generation experiential food interface, setting a new industry standard.

References-

- Norman, D. – *The Design of Everyday Things*
- Nielsen, J. – *Usability Engineering*
- UX Collective – Interactive product configurators
- E-commerce UX research on visual decision-making

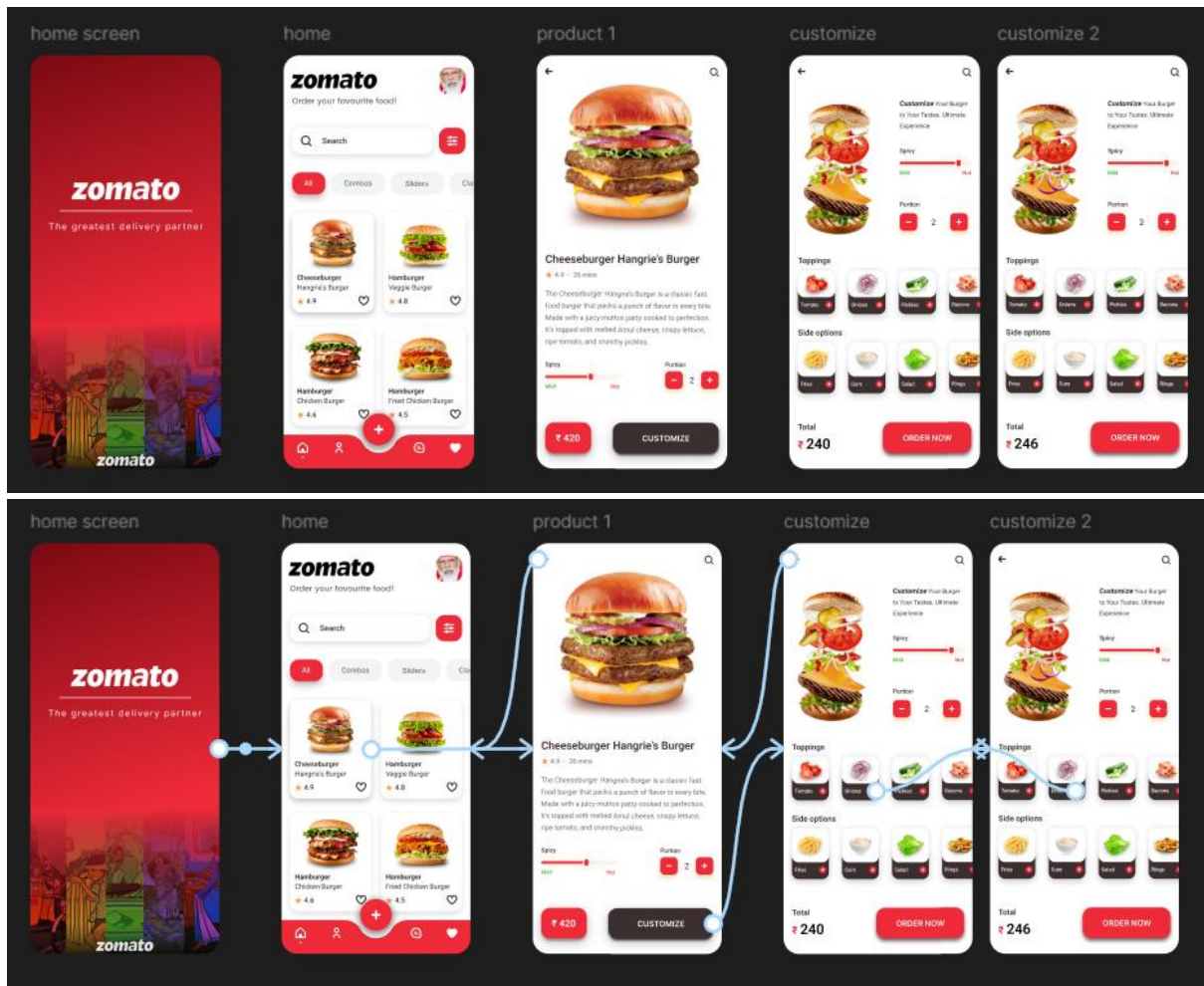


Fig 1.4 – UI frames of our Figma mock-up and prototype view

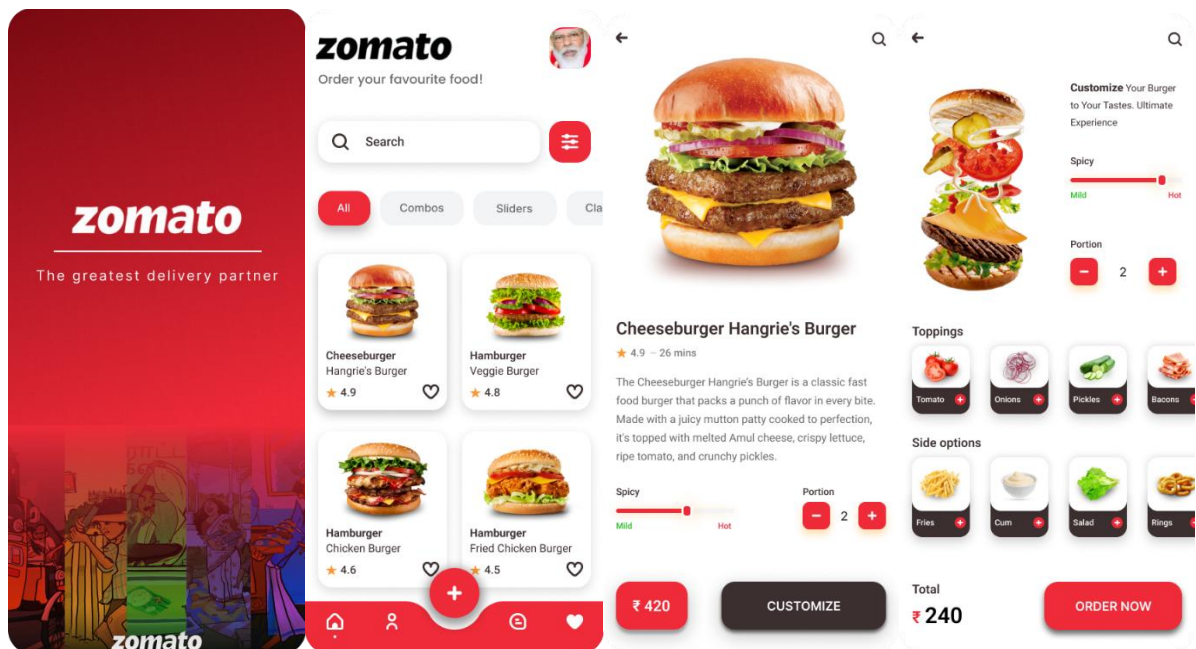


Fig 1.5 – UI frames individually

<https://www.figma.com/design/C6WavElK2hjmK4smG1Arp6/ZOMATO-customizer?node-id=0-1&t=iK5zcY11zCEpLxWD-1>

Link 1.1- Figma view-access link

<https://www.figma.com/proto/C6WavElK2hjmK4smG1Arp6/ZOMATO-customizer?node-id=0-1&t=iK5zcY11zCEpLxWD-1>

Link 1.2-Figma prototype link